

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Why Smells Make Us Feel At Home

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	For the brain, one of the strongest signs of home is _____.
2	One presenter associated home with pine, damp and _____.
3	Another remembered a parent's perfume and a father's _____.
4	After a long trip, a house may smell a bit _____.
5	One possible reason is that the house has been _____ for weeks.
6	The normal smell of home often remains _____ while people are living there.
7	Receptor cells in the nose detect air _____.
8	Olfactory organs analyse smells for possible _____.
9	We stop noticing the smell of home because it is not a _____.
10	Even unnoticed, home scent is linked with comfort and _____.

11 **What central claim is made about home and the brain?**

- A Visual details are the only way to recognise home
- B Smell can strongly identify a place as home
- C People recognise home mainly through sound
- D The brain ignores smell completely

12 **Why are pine, damp, books, perfume and soap mentioned?**

- A To list dangerous household chemicals
- B To compare expensive and cheap smells
- C To show everyone dislikes home smells
- D To give examples of smells connected with home

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **When might people especially notice their home's smell?**
- A After returning from a long trip
 - B Only when moving to a new country
 - C Before leaving for work each day
 - D While watching television at home
- 14 **What alternative explanation is given for a strange smell at home?**
- A The home must have become unsafe
 - B The smell is always caused by cooking
 - C It may simply be the usual smell that was previously unnoticed
 - D The smell proves the house has no ventilation
- 15 **What happens when we breathe in, according to the explanation?**
- A The brain immediately removes all emotions
 - B Nose receptor cells detect molecules in the air
 - C The house stops producing any smell
 - D The limbic system blocks every signal
- 16 **What function do olfactory organs perform?**
- A They analyse smells for danger
 - B They create molecules in the nose
 - C They make familiar smells stronger
 - D They prevent people from breathing smoke
- 17 **Why does filtering out familiar smells help us?**
- A It makes all ordinary smells disappear forever
 - B It stops people from remembering their homes
 - C It makes pleasant smells become dangerous
 - D It helps us notice unusual smells that may signal danger
- 18 **What is the burning toast example used to show?**
- A People usually prefer burnt food
 - B Smoke is never treated as a threat
 - C A change in smell can alert the brain to possible harm
 - D The scent of home always smells like toast

- 19 **What does the word "entangled" suggest about scent and home?**
- A Home scent is closely connected with feelings of comfort and safety
 - B Home scent is separate from emotional memory
 - C Only dangerous smells affect the brain
 - D People can never recognise comfort through smell
- 20 **What broader conclusion is given about smell?**
- A Smell affects only the nose, not the brain
 - B Home smells matter only when they are unpleasant
 - C Smell is weaker than all other senses
 - D Smell is strongly linked to memory, emotion and feeling at home